views, tag helpers, and view components. In this section, I introduce all three features and explain how they are used.

3.3.1 Partial views

A partial view is a Razor (.cshtml) file that contains a chunk of HTML and, optionally, some Razor syntax. It differs from a standard Razor page in that a partial view does not include an `@page` directive because it is not intended to be browsed directly. Partial views can be used

- To break up a complex UI into more manageable pieces
- To avoid repetition of code
- To generate HTML for asynchronous partial page updates in AJAX scenarios

Strangely, there is no partial view template in Visual Studio. You can use any of the options that generate a single Razor file. I usually use the Razor View > Empty template and then remove the default content. VS Code users can just add a new file with a .cshtml suffix or use the CLI to generate a new ViewStart or ViewImports file, then change the filename and remove the default content:

```
dotnet new viewimports
dotnet new viewstart
```

Conventionally, partial views are named with a leading underscore in the filename —_myPartial.cshtml, for example. This convention is not required, but it might help differentiate partials from other files. You can place a partial view anywhere within the Pages folder. The discovery process for partials is the same as for layouts: the folder containing the current page and all parents followed by the Pages\Shared and Views\Shared folders.

The layout file in the application we built so far is very simple, but it could grow to become more complex. Separate sections of the UI are all candidates for partial views. Take the navigation, for example. The code for this area can be separated out into another file, which is then referenced from within the layout file.